

Acceptable Use Policy (AUP)

1. Purpose

The purpose of this Acceptable Use Policy is to define the appropriate use of organizational information systems, networks, and data. This policy aims to protect the confidentiality, integrity, and availability of company resources while ensuring compliance with security standards and regulatory requirements.

2. Scope

This policy applies to:

- All employees, contractors, interns, and third-party users
 - All devices owned or managed by the organization
 - All systems, applications, and data accessed on behalf of the organization
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3. Policy Statement

All users are responsible for using company systems and data in a secure, ethical, and lawful manner. Users must adhere to established security controls and avoid any activity that could harm the organization's systems, data, or reputation.

4. Acceptable Use

Users are permitted to:

- Access systems and data necessary for their job responsibilities
 - Use company resources for legitimate business purposes
 - Follow established security procedures and guidelines
 - Report suspicious activity or security incidents promptly
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5. Prohibited Activities

Users must NOT:

- Access data or systems without proper authorization
 - Share passwords or authentication credentials
 - Install unauthorized software or applications
 - Use company systems for illegal, harmful, or unethical activities
 - Disable or bypass security controls
 - Transmit sensitive data over unsecured channels
 - Engage in excessive personal use that impacts productivity or system performance
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6. Access Control and Authentication

- Users must follow the principle of least privilege
 - Strong passwords and multi-factor authentication (MFA) must be used where required
 - Accounts must not be shared under any circumstances
 - Users are responsible for all activity performed under their credentials
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7. Data Protection

- Sensitive and confidential data must be handled securely at all times
 - Data must be stored only in approved locations
 - Encryption must be used when transmitting sensitive information
 - Users must comply with data classification and handling policies
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8. Monitoring and Privacy

The organization reserves the right to monitor, log, and review user activity on its systems to ensure compliance with this policy and protect organizational assets. Users should have no expectation of privacy when using company resources.

9. Incident Reporting

Users must immediately report:

- Suspected security incidents
- Phishing attempts or suspicious emails
- Unauthorized access or data exposure

Reports should be made to the Information Security team or designated reporting channels.

10. Enforcement

Violations of this policy may result in disciplinary action, including:

- Revocation of system access
 - Formal warnings or termination of employment
 - Legal action, where applicable
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11. Acknowledgment

All users must acknowledge that they have read, understood, and agree to comply with this Acceptable Use Policy before accessing company systems.

12. Review and Updates

This policy will be reviewed periodically and updated as necessary to reflect changes in technology, regulatory requirements, and organizational needs.

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